

The major reason for its success was the built-in DRAM refresh address mechanism that allowed systems to be built with fewer support chips. The Z80 was widely used in Desktop computers and embedded systems like in industrial / professional uses, musical instruments, sample synthesisers, and other consumer electronics.

### Prints In A Flash

The first laser-electrophotographic printer, the IBM 3800, was introduced by IBM in 1975. It had a speed of 20,000 lines per minute; these were reflecting from an 18-sided mirror spinning at 12,000 rpm while the laser beam paths changed a million times per second.

### December: The 5.25-inch Floppy

After the invention of the 8-inch floppy disk at IBM by a team lead by David Noble in 1969, the size of the disk was found to be too large for word processing machines. In 1976, Jim Adkisson of Shugart Associates developed a 5.25-inch minifloppy with a capacity of 98.5KB. Later, the storage was increased to 110 KB. These 5.25-inch drives were comparatively less expensive than IBM's 8-inch drives. Ten more manufacturers started producing 5.25-inch floppies. Later, in 1978, the 5.25-inch floppy drive became an industry standard.

### The First Cray

Seymour Cray, known as the father of supercomputing, along with his research team, designed the Cray-1, the first commercially-successful supercomputer, for Cray Research in 1976. At the Los Alamos National Laboratory, the first Cray-1 system was installed for \$8.8 million (Rs 123 crore today!) It had 8 MB of main memory and could perform operations at a speed of 160 million floating point operations per second.

For the best speed possible, it was designed in a "C" shape with no wire in the system longer than four feet. The entire system was Freon-cooled; there were 20,000 ICs. The Cray X-MP succeeded the Cray-1 in 1982. The National Center for Atmospheric Research paid